



Spoiler

A device on a car or aircraft, often shaped like a wing, that alters the airflow around the vehicle to generate more drag or downforce. Often found on race cars, to keep them gripping the ground.

Spokes

The rods or bars that connect the center, or hub, of a wheel with its rim.

Stern

The rear part of a boat or a vessel.

Streamlined

A streamlined object has smooth curves so that air or water flows easily, increasing movement.

Street-legal

A car, motorcycle, or truck equipped with all the features



required to make it suitable for use on public roads.

Suspension

A system of springs and shock absorbers on a vehicle to help give a smooth ride over bumps and dips.

Supersonic

To fly faster than the speed of sound. The speed of sound is about 768mph (1,236km/h) at sea level.

Switcher

A small locomotive used for moving wagons or train cars around a railroad yard. Also known as a shunter.

Thrust

The force that pushes a powered aircraft through the air, usually generated by an engine.

Tiller

A horizontal bar or handle attached to the rudder of a boat to allow a sailor to steer it.

Ton

A unit of measurement equal to 2,000lb (907.2kg).

Torpedo

A self-propelled underwater weapon with an explosive warhead that is launched

from a ship or submarine and travels toward a set target.

Trunk

A space for storage in a car.

Turbocharger

A device that uses waste gases to boost an engine's power.

Waterline

The level normally reached by the water on the side of a ship.

Wheelhouse

The part of a ship or boat that holds the ship's wheel,

which is used for steering the vessel. In larger ships, the wheelhouse is part of the structure known as the bridge.

VTOL aircraft

Short for vertical takeoff and landing, VTOL refers to aircraft that can use their thrust to head straight up into the air like a helicopter, and so do not require a long runway.

Yard

A long pole, or spar, attached to a ship's mast to which the top of a square sail is fixed.

How a submarine dives

